Physics-Informed Spatio-Temporal Graph Attention for Non-Technical Loss Detection under Positive–Unlabelled Supervision

Problem formulation, mathematical analysis, simulation study and deployment rehearsal

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Abstract

Non-technical losses (NTL) — electricity delivered but not billed, mainly through meter tampering and illegal connections — are usually studied as per-customer classification of consumption time series. This report formulates NTL detection on a low-voltage (LV) network as a ranking problem under a fixed inspection budget, with three structural facts made explicit: (i) every distribution transformer closes an energy balance over the meters it feeds; (ii) utility labels are positive–unlabelled (PU), because uninspected customers are unknown rather than honest; (iii) the operational output is an ordered inspection list. We derive the feeder residual identity and its error terms, show that the conservation constraint is rank-deficient (it fixes the feeder total, not the per-meter allocation), prove that energy-preserving attacks are invisible to it, and derive the closed-form condition under which a PU risk with a misspecified class prior stops rewarding the detection of any positive. A model, PI-STGAT, combines a temporal convolution–attention encoder, a static-attribute encoder, attention among meters sharing a transformer, and a differentiable conservation head that estimates unbilled energy per meter. It is evaluated on a physically motivated LV-network simulator (150 feeders, ≈3,000 meters, 365 days, eight attack types) with five random seeds, and in a deployment rehearsal that runs the full ingestion–training–ranking pipeline on five defective exports with hidden ground truth. On the simulator, static attributes, a positional code in the temporal encoder, and self-supervised pretraining with augmentation each improve ranking on all five seeds, while feeder attention and the conservation branch do not improve discrimination. A per-customer CNN evaluated under a different split is at least as accurate, so an architectural advantage is not established. In the rehearsal the top 5% of each ranking contains 76–93% thieves against a base rate of 16%, and confirmed-only evaluation understates true AUPR by a factor close to the one the analysis predicts. All numerical results are from the author's runs; no real utility data has been used yet.

Status and provenance of every number in this report

- **Measured** values come from one complete run of `run_pipeline.sh` by the author on a single NVIDIA RTX 4080 GPU: five seeds, every experiment in this report, settings in Appendix B. The run's logs, results table and printed summaries are in `outputs/gpu_run/`. Figures 6–14 are the pipeline's five-seed figures, unmodified; Figs. 5 and 13 are drawn by `plot_rehearsal_seeds.py` from the same logs. These values replace those of earlier versions, which used shorter training and three seeds (Section 12).
- **Simulator statistics** (Section 5, Figs. 1 to 4) come from the pipeline's `sim_analysis` step (seed 0 shown; seeds 1–4 quoted as ranges); they involve no model training.
- **Derived** statements are proved from the model and simulator equations, which are transcribed from the source code.
- Paired differences, test-feeder re-scoring, Wilson intervals and bootstrap intervals are computed by `report_numbers.py` or directly from the results table; no value was estimated or filled in by hand.
- No real utility data was used. The simulator was written by the author; this is the main threat to validity (Section 10.1).

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1 Introduction

Utilities can inspect only a small fraction of customers per year. If inspections are allocated poorly, recovered revenue may not cover their cost, so the quantity that matters is the share of true thieves (or of stolen energy) found among the k highest-ranked customers. Most data-driven NTL studies instead report classification accuracy or F1 on balanced benchmark sets [15, 21]; the systematic review of Morgoev et al. [21] (79 papers, 2020–2025) notes that headline scores obtained on curated benchmarks may not transfer to utility environments and identifies reproducibility, imbalance and deployment realism as open problems.

Three properties of the real problem are under-used in that literature:

1. **Energy conservation.** A transformer's measured supply equals the sum of its meters' true consumption plus technical losses. Theft that reduces billed energy therefore leaves a residual at the transformer. Jokar et al. [16] already used transformer meters to short-list suspicious areas, Collier and Guha [5] use a parent–child balance check as a gate before running an LSTM, and Oguntola et al. [23] feed a grid-imbalance index to a GNN as an input feature. Here the balance enters the *training objective* and is attributed to individual meters.
2. **Positive–unlabelled labels.** Confirmed cases come from inspections; everyone else is unlabelled. Hu and Zhen [14] explicitly frame theft detection as PU and use fuzzy clustering with logistic regression; Chen et al. [4] treat anomalies as partially observed. We use the non-negative PU risk of Kiryo et al. [18] and analyse what happens when its class prior is misspecified — the condition under which utilities would actually run it.
3. **Ranking output.** The deliverable is a calibrated ordering and, where possible, an estimate of recoverable energy per meter.

Contributions (stated narrowly).

C1. A formulation of LV-network NTL detection as budgeted ranking under PU labels with a feeder energy-balance constraint, including the residual identity with explicit error terms (Proposition 1), a rank-deficiency result for the constraint (Proposition 2), and invariance results showing which attack classes are unidentifiable from conservation or from permutation-invariant features (Proposition 3).

C2. A closed-form analysis of the sigmoid-loss PU risk under prior misspecification, giving the condition $\hat{\pi} < \pi_u/2$ under which the positive-class term changes sign and the objective is minimised by declaring every meter honest (Proposition 4); defaulting the prior to the confirmed-case rate falls in this regime whenever fewer than roughly one third of thieves are confirmed. In a five-export rehearsal the share of training epochs with validation ROC-AUC below 0.5 falls from 0.22 at that default to 0 at $\hat{\pi} \geq 0.13$, although selecting the best validation epoch recovered comparable final rankings.

C3. PI-STGAT, a 61k-parameter model combining temporal, static, feeder-attention and conservation branches, with a physically coherent augmentation scheme (Proposition 5) and a mask-based conditional VAE whose support provably excludes energy-preserving attacks (Proposition 6).

C4. An evaluation on a simulator with weather-driven demand, quadratic technical losses and eight attacks (two not in the standard benchmark), with five seeds, paired per-seed comparisons, per-attack and per-region breakdowns, and a deployment rehearsal on five defective exports with hidden truth.

We found no prior use, in the sources reviewed, of the non-negative PU estimator combined with

an in-objective feeder conservation term; we do not claim this is exhaustive.

2 Related work and positioning

Table 1 summarises the studies the project was built on and the newer work found during the literature check for this report.

Study	What it uses	Relation to this work
Jokar et al. [16]	Transformer meters to short-list areas; per-customer SVM; six attack functions h_1–h_6	Attack library reused; area screening is a non-differentiable precursor of the conservation term
Buzau et al. [2]	Supervised XGBoost on real Endesa smart-meter data incl. alarms, contract data	Motivates static features; XGBoost baseline
Terciyanlı et al. [29]	Area score; contracted vs consumed energy; fuzzy clustering; inspection feedback	Hand-built expected-vs-billed comparison; ours is learned
Shah et al. [26]	Separate technical from non-technical loss	Technical-loss term τ in our residual
Messinis and Hatziargyriou [20]; Sharma and Majumdar [27]; Nizar et al. [22]; Esmael et al. [9]	Unsupervised / profiling / retrieval	No labels used; complementary
Ghori et al. [10]; Toma et al. [30]; Chatterjee et al. [3]; Iftikhar et al. [15]	Per-customer supervised classifiers	Comparable to our temporal-only branch
Hu and Zhen [14]; Chen et al. [4]	PU framing; partially observed anomalies	PU is not new to NTL; nnPU with prior analysis is our angle
Collier and Guha [5]; Oguntola et al. [23]	Balance check as gate; GNN with imbalance feature	Closest recent work; neither puts the balance in the loss
Morgoev et al. [21]; Ozcanli et al. [24]	Reviews	Taxonomy and open challenges

Table 1: Positioning. The project's novelty is the combination and the analysis, not any single ingredient.

3 Problem formulation

3.1 Network, signals and labels

An LV network has feeders (distribution transformers) $f = 1, \dots, F$. Feeder f serves the meter set $\mathcal{C}_f$ with $K_f = |\mathcal{C}_f|$. Days are $t = 1, \dots, T$. For meter i:

- $x_{i,t} \geq 0$: true daily energy (kWh), never observed;
- $y_{i,t} \geq 0$: reported reading;
- $z_i \in \{0, 1\}$: theft indicator; $y_{i,\cdot} = h(x_{i,\cdot})$ for some attack h if $z_i = 1$, else $y_{i,\cdot} = x_{i,\cdot}$;
- $\boldsymbol{s}_i \in \mathbb{R}^D$: static attributes (contracted power, meter age, tariff, region, ...).

Time averages are written $\bar{x}_i = \frac{1}{T}\sum_t x_{i,t}$, $\bar{y}_i = \frac{1}{T}\sum_t y_{i,t}$, and the *stolen energy* (kWh/day) is

$$\sigma_i \;=\; \bar{x}_i - \bar{y}_i. \tag{1}$$

The transformer head reading is

$$H_{f,t} = \sum_{i \in \mathcal{C}_f} x_{i,t} + \ell_{f,t}, \qquad \ell_{f,t} \geq 0 \text{ (technical loss)}, \tag{2}$$

observed as a time average with multiplicative error, $\bar{H}_f = (1+\varepsilon_f)\frac{1}{T}\sum_t H_{f,t}$. Write $X_f = \sum_{i \in \mathcal{C}_f} \bar{x}_i$ and the feeder loss share $\tau_f = \sum_t \ell_{f,t} / \sum_t \sum_i x_{i,t}$, so $\frac{1}{T}\sum_t H_{f,t} = (1+\tau_f)X_f$.

Labels. A set $\mathcal{P}$ of confirmed thieves is known; all other meters are unlabelled ($\mathcal{U}$), not negative.

3.2 Objective: budgeted ranking

A detector outputs a score $g(\cdot)$ per meter. For a budget of k inspections out of N meters, let $\mathrm{Top}_k(g)$ be the k highest scores.

Definition 1 (Operational metrics)**.**

$$\mathrm{P@}k = \tfrac{1}{k}\textstyle\sum_{i \in \mathrm{Top}_k} z_i, \qquad \mathrm{R@}k = \dfrac{\sum_{i \in \mathrm{Top}_k} z_i}{\sum_i z_i}, \qquad \mathrm{ER@}k = \dfrac{\sum_{i \in \mathrm{Top}_k} \sigma_i}{\sum_i \sigma_i}. \tag{3}$$

P@k is the inspection hit rate; ER@k is the share of stolen energy captured.

Lemma 1 (Optimal ranking keys)**.** *Let $\eta(\boldsymbol{o}) = \mathbb{P}(z = 1 \mid \boldsymbol{o})$ for the observed features $\boldsymbol{o}$ of a meter. Over rankings that may depend only on $\boldsymbol{o}$, (a) ordering by η maximises $\mathbb{E}[\sum_{i \in \mathrm{Top}_k} z_i]$ for every k; (b) ordering by $\mathbb{E}[\sigma \mid \boldsymbol{o}] = \eta(\boldsymbol{o})\,\mathbb{E}[\sigma \mid \boldsymbol{o}, z = 1]$ maximises $\mathbb{E}[\sum_{i \in \mathrm{Top}_k} \sigma_i]$ for every k.*

Proof. $\mathbb{E}[\sum_{i \in S} z_i \mid \boldsymbol{o}_{1:N}] = \sum_{i \in S} \eta(\boldsymbol{o}_i)$ for any set S chosen from the observations, and a sum over $|S| = k$ items is maximised by the k largest terms; same for σ. The factorisation uses $\sigma = 0$ when $z = 0$ (honest meters report truthfully). □

Monotone transforms of g leave every quantity above unchanged; this is why calibration (Section 6.8) does not affect ranking metrics.

4 The feeder energy balance

The model compares the head reading with billed energy through

$$r_f \;=\; \bar{H}_f(1-\hat{\tau}) - \sum_{i \in \mathcal{C}_f} \bar{y}_i, \tag{4}$$

where $\hat{\tau}$ is one global technical-loss share (in simulation: the realised mean of τ_f; on real data: the 25th percentile of healthy feeder residuals, Section 9.7). The training target is $\max(0, r_f)$.

Proposition 1 (Residual identity)**.** *With the definitions above,*

$$r_f = \sum_{i \in \mathcal{C}_f} \sigma_i \;+\; X_f\big[(1+\tau_f)(1-\hat{\tau}) - 1\big] \;+\; \varepsilon_f(1+\tau_f)(1-\hat{\tau})X_f. \tag{5}$$

In particular, with exact loss knowledge ($\hat{\tau} = \tau_f$) and no meter error, $r_f = \sum_i \sigma_i - \tau_f^2 X_f$.

Proof. $\bar{H}_f = (1+\varepsilon_f)(1+\tau_f)X_f$ and $X_f = \sum_i \bar{y}_i + \sum_i \sigma_i$ by (1). Substitute into (4). □

The $-\tau^2 X_f$ term appears because the code uses $\bar{H}(1-\hat{\tau})$ rather than the exact inverse $\bar{H}/(1+\hat{\tau})$; at $\tau \approx 0.064$ it is $\approx 0.4\%$ of feeder energy. The dominant error is the spread of τ_f around $\hat{\tau}$. To first order the error share is $(\tau_f - \hat{\tau}) - \tau_f\hat{\tau} + \varepsilon_f$. In the simulator $\tau_f \sim \mathcal{U}(0.04, 0.09)$ (s.d. $0.05/\sqrt{12} = 0.0144$) and $\varepsilon_f \sim \mathcal{N}(0, 0.01^2)$, giving a predicted error-share s.d. of $\sqrt{0.0144^2 + (1.06 \cdot 0.01)^2} \approx 0.018$. Running the simulator (seed 0, 150 feeders) gives a measured s.d. of 0.0177 and $\mathrm{corr}(r_f, \sum_i \sigma_i) = 0.964$ (Fig. 3); over seeds 0–4 the s.d. is 0.0157–0.0178 and the correlation 0.942–0.980.

Signal-to-noise. In that simulation 62% of feeders contain at least one thief, and among those the stolen share $\sum_i \sigma_i / X_f$ averages 0.072, about four error standard deviations. A single thief removing half of one customer's energy on a 20-meter feeder produces a share of about 0.025, roughly 1.4 standard deviations. The balance therefore identifies feeders with substantial theft and is weak for isolated thieves.

Clamping. For theft-free feeders r_f is approximately zero-mean noise; the target $\max(0, r_f)$ has mean $\approx 0.018/\sqrt{2\pi} \approx 0.007$ of feeder load, so the conservation term asks the model to attribute a small positive amount of theft to honest feeders.

Proposition 2 (Rank deficiency of the conservation constraint)**.** *For feeder f, the set of non-negative per-meter estimates $\{\hat{s}_i\}_{i \in \mathcal{C}_f}$ attaining zero conservation loss $(\sum_i \hat{s}_i - \max(0, r_f))^2$ is the scaled simplex $\{\hat{s} \geq 0 : \sum_i \hat{s}_i = \max(0, r_f)\}$, of dimension $K_f - 1$ when $r_f > 0$.*

Proof. One linear equality in K_f non-negative unknowns. □

Consequently the physics term fixes how much theft a feeder has, never which meter has it. Within-feeder attribution comes only from the shared representation (the other branches). This predicts that adding the physics branch should change feeder-level energy estimates more than meter-level discrimination, which is what the ablation shows (Section 9.2).

Proposition 3 (Energy-preserving attacks)**.** *(a) If $\sum_t y_{i,t} = \sum_t x_{i,t}$ (attacks h_5 flat-mean and h_6 reversal), then $\sigma_i = 0$ and meter i contributes nothing to r_f. (b) Reversal $y_{i,t} = x_{i,T+1-t}$ preserves the multiset $\{x_{i,t}\}$. Every statistic invariant to permutations of the time index (mean, variance, quantiles, zero fraction, skewness, kurtosis) is unchanged; so is the lag-1 autocorrelation, since $\sum_t (x_t - m)(x_{t-1} - m)$ is symmetric under reversal. All ten features of the XGBoost baseline (Section 7) are therefore identical for an honest series and its reversal.*

Proof. (a) is (1). (b) Reversal is a permutation of indices; the lag-1 sum runs over the same unordered pairs of neighbours. □

Remark 1 (Why h_6 is hard for this design). In the simulator, honest demand is (approximately) time-reversible: a 7-day weekly pattern reversed is a cyclic shift of itself (since $364 = 52 \cdot 7$, day-of-week maps $d \mapsto -d \bmod 7$), the AR(1) Gaussian weather noise and i.i.d. log-normal noise are time-reversible, and a reversed annual sinusoid is a phase-shifted sinusoid. The temporal encoder (Section 6) has convolutions (translation-equivariant), self-attention *without positional encoding* (permutation-equivariant over tokens) and mean/max pooling. It has no calendar reference, so it can detect reversal only through local asymmetries. The one reference that would expose reversal — neighbours on the same feeder see the same weather at the same time — is lost because time is pooled *before* the feeder-attention stage. The argument predicts that a calendar reference should help. Recall@10% for h_6 is 0.28 for the full model (36 test instances over five seeds; random ranking gives 0.10), so the encoder does pick up some local asymmetry. Adding a sinusoidal positional code to the temporal tokens (`-pos-enc`) raises it to 0.48 and raises AUPR on all five seeds (Section 9.2), as predicted; it also lowers h_1 recall from 0.53 to 0.36. A further test is to compare each meter's token sequence with its feeder's mean profile before pooling.

5 Simulation model

No public dataset contains meter series, meter-to-transformer topology, transformer readings and theft labels together, so the experiments use a simulator (file `ntl/simulator.py`). Each equation below is transcribed from that file; Table 7 lists the constants.

5.1 Weather and demand

Temperature (°C) for day $t = 0, \dots, T-1$:

$$\theta_t = 12 + 9\sin\Big(\tfrac{2\pi(t-110)}{365}\Big) + e_t, \qquad e_t = 0.7\, e_{t-1} + \eta_t, \quad \eta_t \sim \mathcal{N}(0, 1.8^2). \tag{6}$$

Each meter draws an archetype $a \in \{\text{res}, \text{com}, \text{ind}\}$ with probabilities $(0.6, 0.3, 0.1)$ and true demand

$$x_{i,t} = L_i\, w_i(t)\, \kappa_i(\theta_t)\, \nu_{i,t}, \qquad \kappa_i(\theta) = 1 + h_i(15-\theta)_+ + c_i(\theta - 24)_+, \tag{7}$$

with level $\ln L_i \sim \mathcal{N}(\ln b_a, 0.45^2)$, $b = (9, 25, 60)$ kWh/day; weekend factor $w_i(t) = \omega_i$ on days with $t \bmod 7 \in \{5, 6\}$, else 1; heating/cooling slopes h_i, c_i uniform on archetype-specific ranges; noise $\ln \nu_{i,t} \sim \mathcal{N}(0, 0.1^2)$ i.i.d. Residential meters receive 0 or 1 vacancy period of 3–11 days scaled by $\mathcal{U}(0, 0.3)$.

5.2 Theft assignment and attacks

A feeder is "hot" with probability 0.25. Each meter on a hot feeder is a thief with probability 0.45, otherwise 0.03, so the expected prevalence is

$$\pi = 0.25 \cdot 0.45 + 0.75 \cdot 0.03 = 0.135; \tag{8}$$

the seed-0 network has 3,104 meters on 150 feeders with prevalence 0.133 (seeds 0–4: 2,973–3,249 meters, prevalence 0.111–0.174). A thief draws one attack uniformly from eight (Table 2): the six functions of Jokar et al. [16] and two added here.

ID	Reported series y_t	$\mathbb{E}[\sigma/\bar{x}]$ (derived)	mean in sim
h_1 scale	$a\, x_t$, $a \sim \mathcal{U}(0.1, 0.8)$	0.55	0.525
h_2 zero window	0 on a random window of length $\geq \lfloor T/20 \rfloor$, else x_t	window-dependent	0.220
h_3 per-step	$g_t x_t$, $g_t \overset{iid}{\sim} \mathcal{U}(0.1, 0.8)$	0.55	0.550
h_4 fraction of mean	$g_t\, \bar{x}$, $g_t \overset{iid}{\sim} \mathcal{U}(0.1, 0.8)$	0.55	0.550
h_5 flat mean	$\bar{x}$	0	0.000
h_6 reversal	x_{T+1-t}	0	0.000
h_7 seasonal-gated (new)	$a\, x_t$ if $x_t \geq Q_{0.6}(x)$, else x_t; $a \sim \mathcal{U}(0.2, 0.6)$	0.6×(energy share of top 40% days)	0.285
h_8 ramp (new)	$x_t\big(1 - \beta \frac{t}{T-1}\big)$, $\beta \sim \mathcal{U}(0.4, 0.85)$	$\mathbb{E}[\beta]/2 = 0.3125$	0.320

Table 2: Attack functions (`ntl/data.py`, `ntl/simulator.py`). The last column is measured over all thieves of the seed-0 network (counts per attack 34–70).

5.3 Static attributes

For each meter: contracted power $= \bar{x}_i \cdot \mathcal{U}$(archetype range) (computed from *true* consumption); meter age $\sim \mathcal{N}(9, 3^2)$ for thieves and $\mathcal{N}(7, 3^2)$ otherwise, clipped to $[0, 20]$; alarm count $\sim$ Poisson(1.8) for thieves and Poisson(0.8) otherwise; region index near 0.6 on hot and 0.4 on cold feeders; tariff (matching archetype with probability 0.85); archetype one-hot. $D = 10$.

Assumption 1 (Label-dependent static attributes)**.** Meter age and alarm counts are drawn from label-dependent distributions, contracted power is tied to true rather than reported consumption, and region is correlated with theft through hot feeders. This encodes field reports that tampered meters are older and raise more alarms [2] and that billed energy falls below contracted capacity [29], but the *strength* of these signals is the author's choice.

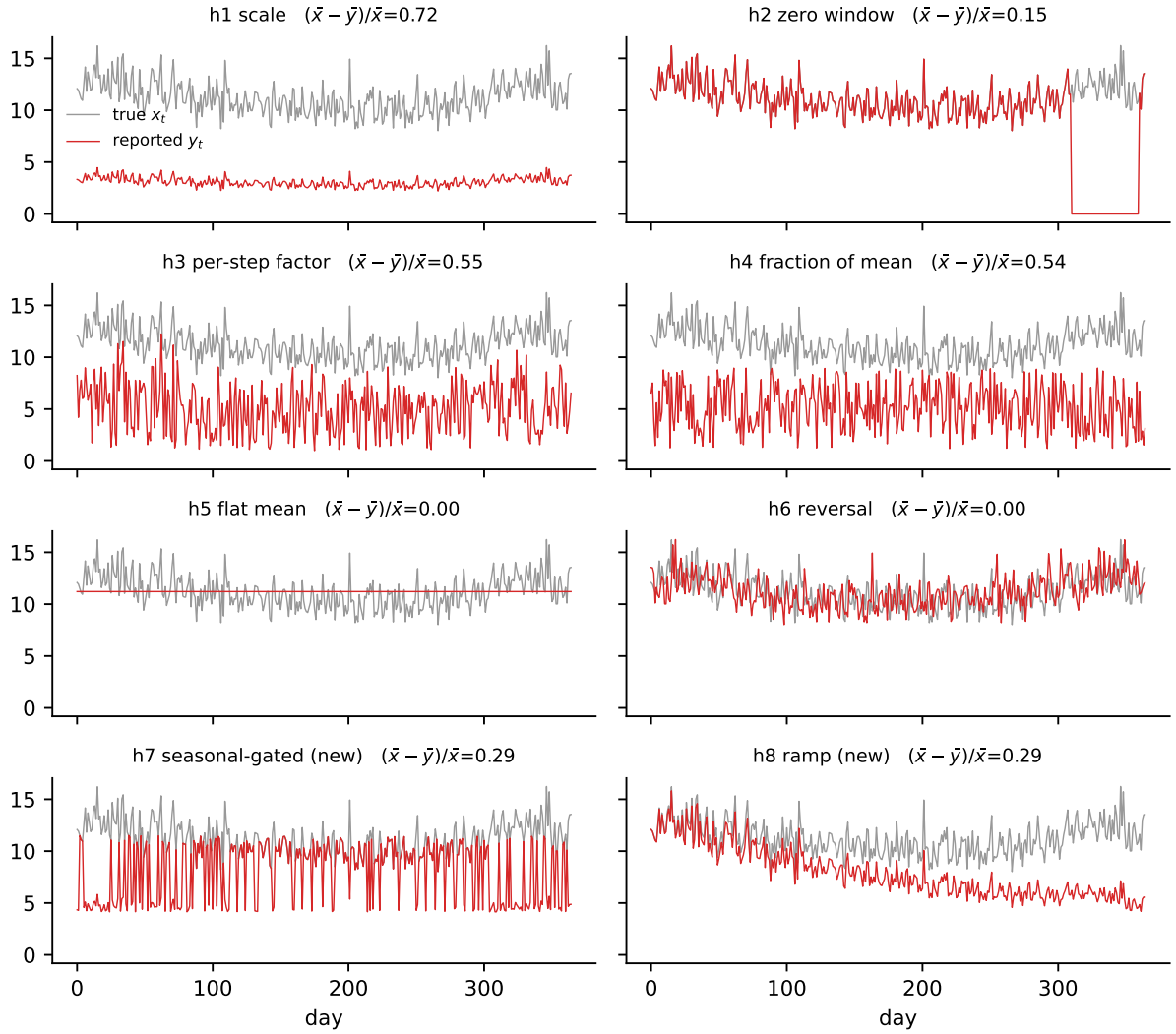


Figure 1: The eight attacks applied to one honest residential meter of the seed-0 network. h_5 and h_6 steal no energy on average (Proposition 3).

To quantify how much signal this injects, each attribute was scored alone against the labels (ROC-AUC, no training; seed 0, with the range over seeds 0–4 in brackets): meter age 0.685 [0.665–0.685]; alarms 0.700 [0.700–0.732]; contracted power / reported mean 0.817 [0.806–0.843]; region 0.789 [0.707–0.789]. Any gain from the static branch on simulated data is bounded by, and partly produced by, this assumption.

5.4 Technical losses and head readings

Per feeder, with $d_i \sim \mathcal{U}(0.3, 1)$ a per-customer line factor,

$$\tilde{\ell}_{f,t} = \sum_{i \in \mathcal{C}_f} d_i \, x_{i,t}^2 + 0.3 \, \frac{\left(\sum_i x_{i,t}\right)^2}{K_f}, \qquad \ell_{f,t} = \lambda_f \tilde{\ell}_{f,t}, \quad \lambda_f = \frac{\tau_f \sum_t \sum_i x_{i,t}}{\sum_t \tilde{\ell}_{f,t}}, \quad \tau_f \sim \mathcal{U}(0.04, 0.09), \tag{9}$$

i.e. an I^2R-type line term plus a transformer copper-loss term, scaled so the annual loss share equals τ_f. Because losses are quadratic in load, the daily loss share varies with demand (0.062–0.106 on feeder 0, Fig. 2); the model's single $\hat{\tau}$ is an approximation.

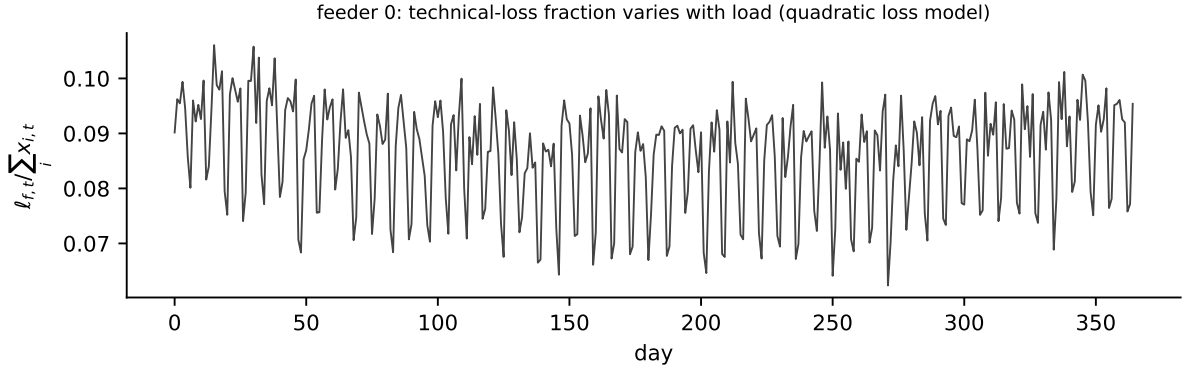


Figure 2: Daily technical-loss share on one simulated feeder. A constant-share assumption is an approximation even before real-world effects.

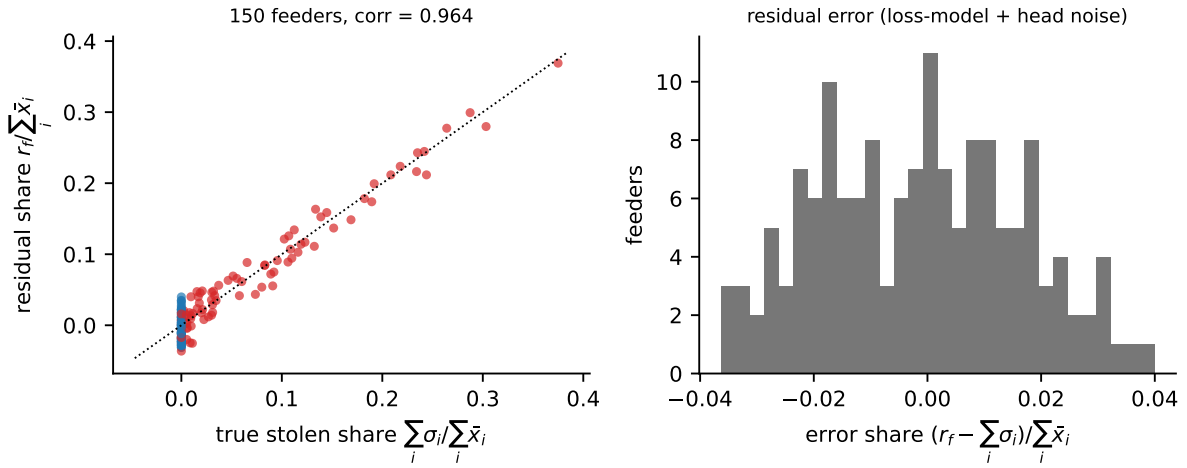


Figure 3: Left: feeder residual share vs true stolen share for the 150 seed-0 feeders (red: at least one thief). Right: error distribution, s.d. 0.0177, matching the prediction 0.018 from Proposition 1.

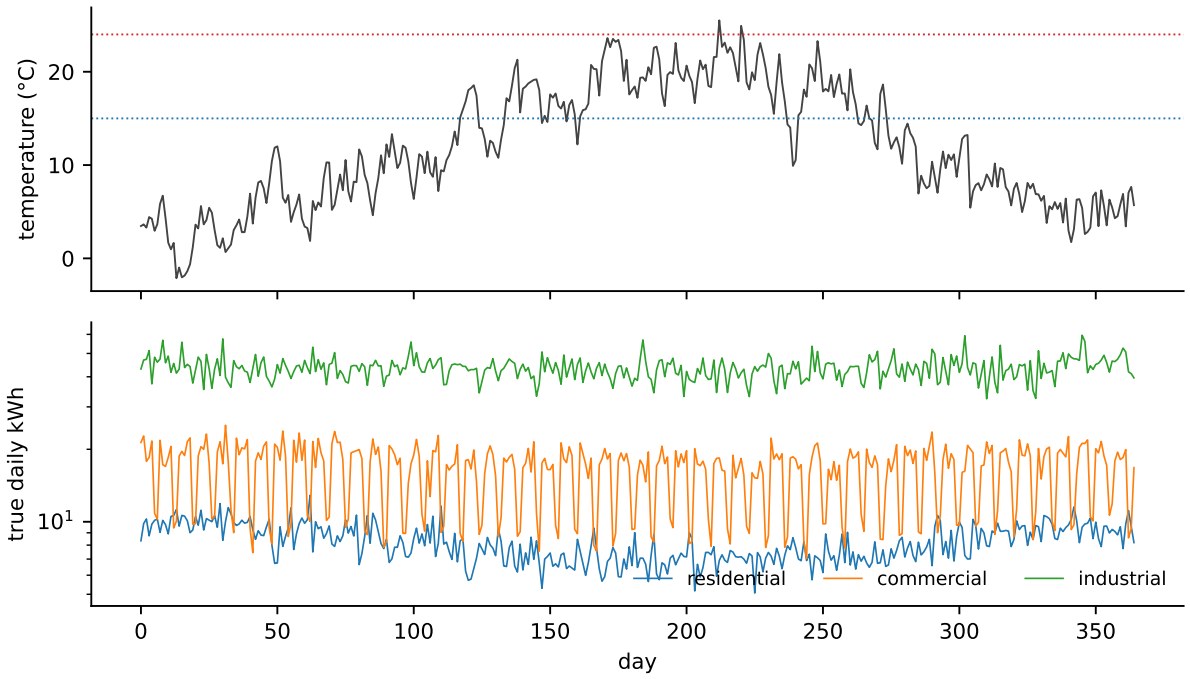


Figure 4: Simulated temperature (dotted: heating and cooling thresholds) and one true series per archetype (log scale).

5.5 Second generator for the baselines

A simpler per-customer generator (`ntl/data.py`) produces 4,000 independent series with a random-phase annual sinusoid (amplitude 0.35), weekend factor $\mathcal{U}(1.1, 1.4)$, log-normal level, Gaussian noise and vacancy gaps; 9% become thieves under h_1–h_6. It has no feeders, heads or static attributes and is used only for the baseline comparison.

6 Model: PI-STGAT

6.1 Input normalisation

Series are transformed as $\tilde{y}_{i,t} = (\log(1 + y_{i,t}) - \mu)/s$ with scalars μ, s fitted on training-split meters. Static vectors are standardised per column on the training split. Energies entering the conservation term are divided by u, the mean head reading of training feeders.

6.2 Branches

Temporal. Two dilated 1-D convolution blocks (32 and 64 channels, kernel 5, dilation 1 and 2; batch norm, ReLU, dropout 0.2) give a receptive field of $1 + 4 \cdot 1 + 4 \cdot 2 = 13$ days. Max-pooling by 4 yields $T' = \lfloor T/4 \rfloor$ tokens (91 for $T = 365$), projected to $d = 64$. Multi-head self-attention (4 heads, head dimension 16; no positional encoding) is applied with a residual connection and layer norm:

$$\boldsymbol{U} = \mathrm{LN}(\boldsymbol{V} + \mathrm{MHA}(\boldsymbol{V}, \boldsymbol{V}, \boldsymbol{V})), \qquad \mathrm{head}_j = \mathrm{softmax}\Big(\frac{\boldsymbol{V}\boldsymbol{W}_j^Q (\boldsymbol{V}\boldsymbol{W}_j^K)^\top}{\sqrt{16}}\Big)\boldsymbol{V}\boldsymbol{W}_j^V. \tag{10}$$

The readout is $\boldsymbol{h}_i^{\mathrm{tmp}} = [\mathrm{mean}_t \boldsymbol{U};\ \max_t \boldsymbol{U}] \in \mathbb{R}^{128}$.

Static. $\boldsymbol{h}_i^{\mathrm{st}} = \boldsymbol{W}_2\,\mathrm{ReLU}(\boldsymbol{W}_1\boldsymbol{s}_i)$, $\mathbb{R}^D \to \mathbb{R}^{64} \to \mathbb{R}^{32}$.

Fusion. $\boldsymbol{h}_i = \mathrm{ReLU}(\boldsymbol{W}_f[\boldsymbol{h}_i^{\mathrm{tmp}}; \boldsymbol{h}_i^{\mathrm{st}}]) \in \mathbb{R}^{64}$.

Feeder attention. Meters of one feeder are padded into a batch row with mask $m \in \{0,1\}^{K_{\max}}$ and updated by masked multi-head attention (padding rows are excluded from the temporal encoder, so they do not reach batch normalisation):

$$\boldsymbol{h}_i \leftarrow \mathrm{LN}\Big(\boldsymbol{h}_i + \sum_{j \in \mathcal{C}_f} \alpha_{ij} \boldsymbol{W}^V \boldsymbol{h}_j\Big), \qquad \alpha_{ij} = \frac{\exp(q_i^\top k_j/\sqrt{16})}{\sum_{j' \in \mathcal{C}_f} \exp(q_i^\top k_{j'}/\sqrt{16})} \tag{11}$$

(per head). The graph is the disjoint union of complete graphs, one per transformer; the model uses feeder *membership*, not line distances or electrical topology within the feeder.

Conservation head and classifier.

$$\hat{s}_i = \mathrm{softplus}(\boldsymbol{w}_s^\top \boldsymbol{h}_i + b_s) \geq 0, \qquad g_i = \boldsymbol{w}_c^\top [\boldsymbol{h}_i; \hat{s}_i] + b_c, \qquad \hat{p}_i = \mathrm{sigm}(g_i/t^\star). \tag{12}$$

b_s is initialised to -4 ($\mathrm{softplus}(-4) \approx 0.018$) so the conservation term starts small. Without the physics branch, $\hat{s}_i \equiv 0$ and $g_i = \boldsymbol{w}_c^\top \boldsymbol{h}_i + b_c$.

Size. Parameter counts printed by the training script: temporal only 39,937; + static 44,769; + feeder attention 61,537; full (simulator, $D = 10$) 61,603; full on the rehearsal export ($D = 3$; the region column is excluded from the inputs on real-format data) 61,155. The baseline 1-D CNN has 68,545.

6.3 Training objective

$$\mathcal{L} = \mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{cls}} + \lambda\,\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{cons}}, \qquad \mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{cons}} = \frac{1}{B} \sum_{f \in \mathrm{batch}} \Big(\sum_{i \in \mathcal{C}_f} \hat{s}_i - \max\left(0, r_f/u\right) \Big)^2, \qquad \lambda = 0.5. \tag{13}$$

Fully labelled case: focal loss [19], with $p_t = \hat{p}$ if $z = 1$ and $1 - \hat{p}$ otherwise,

$$\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{cls}} = \frac{1}{N_b} \sum_i -\alpha_{z_i} (1 - p_{t,i})^\gamma \log p_{t,i}, \qquad \alpha_1 = 0.75,\ \alpha_0 = 0.25,\ \gamma = 2. \tag{14}$$

The factor $(1 - p_t)^\gamma$ down-weights well-classified (mostly honest) examples.

Positive–unlabelled case (Section 6.4).

Optimisation. Adam, learning rate 10^{-3}, weight decay 10^{-4}, batches of 16 feeders, 200 epochs in the reported run; the epoch with the highest validation AUPR is kept.

6.4 Positive–unlabelled learning

Assumption 2 (SCAR)**.** Confirmed thieves are a uniformly random subset of all thieves ("selected completely at random" [1, 8]): $\mathbb{P}(\text{confirmed} \mid z = 1, \boldsymbol{o}) = c$, constant.

Real inspection outcomes violate SCAR, because inspections are targeted; the rehearsal export satisfies it by construction (random 30% reveal). See Section 10.1. In simulator PU runs the hidden labels are hidden on the validation split too, so epoch selection, calibration and the threshold use only confirmed labels; the test split keeps full labels for evaluation. The default prior in simulator runs is still the true prevalence, which a utility would not know.

Unbiased risk. With the sigmoid loss $\ell(g,+1) = \mathrm{sigm}(-g)$, $\ell(g,-1) = \mathrm{sigm}(g)$, let p_+, p_- be the class-conditional feature distributions. Under SCAR the labelled set is a sample of p_+ and the unlabelled set a sample of $p_u = \pi_u p_+ + (1-\pi_u)p_-$, where π_u is the positive fraction among *unlabelled* meters. Since $(1-\pi_u)\mathbb{E}_-[\ell(g,-1)] = \mathbb{E}_u[\ell(g,-1)] - \pi_u\mathbb{E}_+[\ell(g,-1)]$, the risk with class prior π_u can be estimated from labelled and unlabelled data only [18]:

$$\widehat{R}(g) = \hat{\pi}\,\widehat{R}_+^+ + \underbrace{(\widehat{R}_u^- - \hat{\pi}\,\widehat{R}_+^-)}_{\widehat{R}_{\mathrm{neg}}}, \qquad \widehat{R}_+^{\pm} = \tfrac{1}{|\mathcal{P}|}\textstyle\sum_{i\in\mathcal{P}} \mathrm{sigm}(\mp g_i), \quad \widehat{R}_u^- = \tfrac{1}{|\mathcal{U}|}\textstyle\sum_{i\in\mathcal{U}} \mathrm{sigm}(g_i). \tag{15}$$

Non-negative correction as implemented. $\widehat{R}_{\mathrm{neg}}$ estimates a non-negative quantity but can become negative under overfitting. In `ntl/pu.py`, per mini-batch: if $\widehat{R}_{\mathrm{neg}} < 0$ the returned loss is $\hat{\pi}\widehat{R}_+^+ - \widehat{R}_{\mathrm{neg}}$ (so the gradient step raises $\widehat{R}_{\mathrm{neg}}$ back toward zero), else $\hat{\pi}\widehat{R}_+^+ + \widehat{R}_{\mathrm{neg}}$; this is the $\beta = 0, \gamma = 1$ form of Kiryo et al. [18].

Which prior. The code's unlabelled set excludes confirmed meters, so the consistent prior is π_u, not the overall prevalence π. If ρ is the observed confirmed fraction,

$$\pi_u = \frac{\pi - \rho}{1-\rho}, \qquad c = \rho/\pi. \tag{16}$$

Proposition 4 (Prior misspecification)**.** *Under Assumption 2, the population objective* $\mathbb{E}[\widehat{R}]$ *with prior* $\hat{\pi}$ *equals*

$$\mathbb{E}[\widehat{R}(g)] = (2\hat{\pi} - \pi_u)\,\mathbb{E}_+\big[\,\mathrm{sigm}(-g)\big] + (1-\pi_u)\,\mathbb{E}_-\big[\,\mathrm{sigm}(g)\big] + (\pi_u - \hat{\pi}). \tag{17}$$

If $\hat{\pi} < \pi_u/2$*, the coefficient* $a = 2\hat{\pi} - \pi_u$ *is negative. Using* $\mathrm{sigm}(-g) = 1 - \mathrm{sigm}(g)$ *the objective becomes* $|a|\,\mathbb{E}_+[\mathrm{sigm}(g)] + (1-\pi_u)\,\mathbb{E}_-[\mathrm{sigm}(g)] +$ *const: both classes are driven toward "honest", and the population minimiser (*$g \to -\infty$ *everywhere) flags no meter. Separating the classes is no longer rewarded; any ranking that survives comes only from negatives being pushed down with weight* $1-\pi_u$ *against* $|a|$ *for positives.*

Proof. $\mathbb{E}_u[\mathrm{sigm}(g)] = \pi_u\mathbb{E}_+[\mathrm{sigm}(g)] + (1-\pi_u)\mathbb{E}_-[\mathrm{sigm}(g)]$, hence $\mathbb{E}[\widehat{R}] = \hat{\pi}\mathbb{E}_+\,\mathrm{sigm}(-g) + (\pi_u - \hat{\pi})\mathbb{E}_+\,\mathrm{sigm}(g) + (1-\pi_u)\mathbb{E}_-\,\mathrm{sigm}(g)$. The sigmoid loss satisfies $\mathrm{sigm}(g) + \mathrm{sigm}(-g) = 1$, so $\mathbb{E}_+\,\mathrm{sigm}(g) = 1 - \mathbb{E}_+\,\mathrm{sigm}(-g)$; collect terms. When $\hat{\pi}$ is small, $\widehat{R}_{\mathrm{neg}}$ stays positive and the non-negative branch is inactive, so (17) is the objective actually optimised. □

Consequence for the default prior. Setting $\hat{\pi} = \rho$ (the confirmed-case rate, the only prevalence a utility observes without an audit) makes $a < 0$ iff $\rho < \pi_u/2$, i.e. $\pi > \rho(3-2\rho) \approx 3\rho$; equivalently $c \lesssim 1/3$. In the five rehearsal exports 30% of thieves were confirmed, $\rho = 0.032$–0.044 among kept meters and the true prevalence was 0.105–0.145, so (16) gives $\pi_u = 0.075$–0.106 and $a = 2\hat{\pi} - \pi_u \in [-0.018, -0.009]$: negative on every export.

What the proposition does and does not predict. It describes the population minimiser. A finite network trained for a finite number of epochs need not reach it, and model selection on validation AUPR can keep an early or favourable epoch. The testable consequence is therefore instability during training, not a fixed final outcome. Section 9.7 reports both: the share of epochs with validation ROC-AUC below 0.5 falls steadily as $\hat{\pi}$ grows, while final rankings after model selection do not differ consistently between priors. The fall is gradual rather than a jump at $a = 0$: at $\hat{\pi} = 0.06$, $a > 0$ on every export, yet one export still spent 48% of its epochs below 0.5. The proposition suggests $\hat{\pi} \approx \pi_u$ as the consistent choice; the sweep shows no consistent peak there.

6.5 Physically coherent augmentation

During training, each honest meter is converted with probability p into a synthetic thief: $y \mapsto \tilde{y} = A(y)$ for an augmenter A, label set to 1, marked as a known positive under PU, and the head reading left unchanged.

Proposition 5 (Coherence)**.** *After augmenting honest meter j on feeder f, the residual becomes $r_f + \tilde{\sigma}_j$ with $\tilde{\sigma}_j = \bar{y}_j - \bar{\tilde{y}}_j$, which is exactly the residual (5) of a network in which meter j steals $\tilde{\sigma}_j$.*

Proof. True consumption and $\bar{H}_f$ are unchanged; only $\bar{y}_j$ in (4) changes. For an honest meter $\bar{x}_j = \bar{y}_j$, so $\tilde{\sigma}_j = \bar{x}_j - \bar{\tilde{y}}_j$ is its stolen energy. □

Synthetic positives are generated only for training-split feeders, after the feeder-level split, so no synthetic sample is derived from a validation or test meter. Under PU, conversion applies to every unlabelled meter, because a hidden thief cannot be told apart from an honest one, and the cVAE trains on confirmed pairs only.

6.6 Learned augmenter: conditional VAE over theft masks

For a theft pair (x, y) define the mask $m_t = \mathrm{clip}(y_t/x_t, 0, 1)$ (1 where $x_t \le 10^{-3}$), downsampled by adaptive average pooling to length 64. The condition is $\boldsymbol{c} = [\mathrm{shape}(x/\bar{x}) \in \mathbb{R}^{32};\ \log \bar{x}]$. Encoder $q_\phi(\boldsymbol{z} \mid \boldsymbol{m}, \boldsymbol{c}) = \mathcal{N}(\boldsymbol{\mu}, \mathrm{diag}\, e^{\boldsymbol{v}})$ with $\boldsymbol{z} \in \mathbb{R}^{16}$; decoder $\hat{\boldsymbol{m}} = \mathrm{sigm}(\mathrm{MLP}([\boldsymbol{z}; \boldsymbol{c}]))$. Loss (full batch, Adam 10^{-3}, 2,000 epochs in the reported run):

$$\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{VAE}} = \|\hat{\boldsymbol{m}} - \boldsymbol{m}\|_2^2/64 + \beta\, \mathrm{KL}(q_\phi \,\|\, \mathcal{N}(0, I)), \quad \mathrm{KL} = -\tfrac{1}{2}\textstyle\sum_{k=1}^{16}(1 + v_k - \mu_k^2 - e^{v_k}), \quad \beta = 0.01, \tag{18}$$

with the reparameterisation $\boldsymbol{z} = \boldsymbol{\mu} + e^{\boldsymbol{v}/2} \odot \boldsymbol{\epsilon}$ [17, 28]. Sampling: $\boldsymbol{z} \sim \mathcal{N}(0, I)$, decode, linearly interpolate to length T, $\tilde{y} = \hat{m} \odot y$.

Proposition 6 (Support)**.** *Every sample satisfies $0 < \tilde{y}_t < y_t$ wherever $y_t > 0$, hence $\tilde{\sigma} > 0$. Energy-preserving attacks (h_5, h_6) are outside the generator's support.*

Proof. Sigmoid outputs lie in $(0, 1)$ and linear interpolation of values in $(0, 1)$ stays in $(0, 1)$. An attack with $\sum_t y_t = \sum_t x_t$ and $y \neq x$ requires $y_t > x_t$ for some t, i.e. $m_t > 1$. □

Training pairs require the true series. In simulation they are known; on real data they would be the post-inspection corrected consumption of confirmed cases (not yet available, so the learned augmenter is disabled in real mode).

6.7 Self-supervised pretraining

The temporal encoder is pretrained on training-split series by masked-span reconstruction: random spans of 5–21 days are hidden until 30% of each series is covered, hidden values are set to 0 (the normalised mean), and a per-token linear decoder ($\mathbb{R}^{64} \to \mathbb{R}^4$) reconstructs the series; the loss is mean squared error on hidden positions only (Adam 10^{-3}, weight decay 10^{-5}, batch 256, 50 epochs in the reported run). Weights are then copied into the temporal branch. This follows masked autoencoding [13]; spans are used because single missing days are trivially interpolated.

6.8 Calibration, threshold and outputs

A temperature $t^\star = \arg\min_{t \in [0.5,10]} \mathrm{BCE}(\mathrm{sigm}(g/t), z)$ is fitted on the validation split by L-BFGS [11]. Because $g \mapsto g/t$ is monotone, AUPR, ROC-AUC, P@k, R@k and ER@k are unchanged by calibration. The decision threshold maximises F1 on calibrated validation probabilities and is used only for flag rates and F1. In the fully labelled simulator runs the fitted temperature was 0.50–0.96 and often at the lower bound 0.5 (the optimiser would have sharpened further); in PU simulator runs it was 1.4–3.0, and in the rehearsal with $\hat{\pi} = 0.13$ it was 1.24–2.77. On real-format data calibration uses confirmed labels, so $\hat{p}$ estimates the probability of being a *confirmed* case, which is lower than the probability of theft.

The ranking export contains $\hat{p}_i$, $\hat{s}_i u$ (estimated kWh/day) and the product $\hat{p}_i \hat{s}_i$.

Remark 2 (Ranking key). By Lemma 1(b) the energy-optimal key is $\mathbb{E}[\sigma \mid \boldsymbol{o}]$. The conservation head is trained to make $\sum_i \hat{s}_i$ match the *unconditional* feeder theft, so $\hat{s}_i$ targets $\mathbb{E}[\sigma_i \mid \cdot]$ itself, which already contains the theft probability. Ranking by $\hat{p}_i \hat{s}_i$ then counts the probability twice. Ranking by $\hat{s}_i$ alone is the key the theory suggests; it has not been evaluated. Empirically $\hat{p}\hat{s}$ captured slightly more stolen energy than $\hat{p}$ (Section 9.4).

7 Baselines

1-D CNN. Three dilated convolution blocks (32/64/128 channels, kernel 5, dilations 1/2/4), mean+max pooling, MLP head; focal loss; on-the-fly h_1–h_6 augmentation with $p = 0.15$; 150 epochs in the reported run, batch 128; customer-level stratified 70/15/15 split.

XGBoost [2]. Ten per-customer features: mean, s.d., min, max, median, zero-day fraction, skewness, kurtosis, coefficient of variation, lag-1 autocorrelation; 400 trees, depth 5, learning rate 0.05, subsampling 0.9, `scale_pos_weight` $= n_-/n_+$; no augmentation; same split protocol as the CNN.

8 Evaluation protocol

Splits. PI-STGAT splits whole feeders 70/15/15 (train/validation/test), so no test meter's neighbours appear in training. Baselines split customers.

Metrics. AUPR is average precision, $\mathrm{AP} = \sum_n (R_n - R_{n-1}) P_n$; ROC-AUC equals $\mathbb{P}(g_+ > g_-)$ [12]. AUPR is preferred under imbalance [6, 25], but it depends on prevalence: at a fixed operating point,

$$\text{precision} = \frac{\pi\,\mathrm{TPR}}{\pi\,\mathrm{TPR} + (1-\pi)\,\mathrm{FPR}}, \tag{19}$$

and a random score has $\mathbb{E}[\mathrm{AP}] \approx \pi$. AUPR values are comparable only at equal prevalence; ROC-AUC is prevalence-invariant. Recall at a budget is capped by prevalence:

$$\mathrm{R@}k \le \min\left(1,\, k/(N\pi)\right), \tag{20}$$

so with feeder-clustered theft and a 15% feeder test split, R@10% varies strongly between seeds through the test prevalence alone.

Evaluation under PU labels. On real data only confirmed labels exist.

Proposition 7 (Confirmed-only evaluation)**.** *Under Assumption 2 with labelling frequency c on the evaluation set, for every threshold $\mathbb{E}[\mathrm{TP}_{\mathrm{vis}}] = c\,\mathrm{TP}$ while the number flagged is unchanged, so $\mathbb{E}[\mathrm{precision}_{\mathrm{vis}}] = c \cdot \mathrm{precision}$ and $\mathbb{E}[\mathrm{recall}_{\mathrm{vis}}] = \mathrm{recall}$. Hence $\mathrm{AP}_{\mathrm{vis}} \approx c \cdot \mathrm{AP}_{\mathrm{true}}$ (in expectation, for large samples), and confirmed-only AUPR understates true AUPR by a factor of about $1/c$. For ROC-AUC, $\mathrm{AUC}_{\mathrm{vis}} \approx \pi_u \cdot \frac{1}{2} + (1 - \pi_u)\mathrm{AUC}_{\mathrm{true}}$.*

Proof. Each true positive is visible independently with probability c; AP integrates precision over recall. For ROC, a confirmed positive is compared against an unlabelled meter that is a hidden positive with probability π_u (coin flip on average) and a negative otherwise. □

Seeds. The seed controls both the simulated network and the model initialisation, so seed-to-seed spread includes data variation.

9 Results

Experiment	Data	Runs
Baselines	per-customer generator, 4,000 meters, $T = 365$, 9.2% test prevalence	5 seeds each
Baseline CNN on simulator	each seed's simulator network flattened to per-customer rows (2,973–3,249 meters)	5 seeds
Ablation (4 configurations)	simulator, 150 feeders, $T = 365$, prevalence 0.111–0.174	5 seeds each
Variants of the full model	SSL + augmentation; positional code; region removed; label-free age and alarms; PU with 30% revealed, with and without SSL	5 seeds each
Unseen-attack experiment	train 2,099–2,326 meters, h_1–h_4 only, 2.9–3.7%; test on an independent network of 1,098–1,245 meters, h_1–h_8, 9.5–17.4%	5 seeds × 4
Deployment rehearsal	one defective export per seed, 60 feeders, $T = 240$; 1,061–1,291 meters used; 5 priors	5 exports × 5 priors

Table 3: Experiments in the reported run. Counts are those printed by the scripts. The seed fixes the network, the split and the initialisation, so seed-to-seed spread includes data variation.

9.1 Baselines and the per-customer comparison

On the per-customer generator the CNN reaches AUPR 0.938 ± 0.024 / ROC-AUC 0.973 ± 0.014 and XGBoost 0.802 ± 0.034 / 0.884 ± 0.016 (mean ± s.d. over 5 seeds, prevalence 0.092). On the simulator the CNN, given each meter's reported series only, reaches 0.950 ± 0.021 / 0.978 ± 0.010; full PI-STGAT reaches 0.935 ± 0.028 / 0.977 ± 0.010.

This comparison does not show an advantage for PI-STGAT. It is also not controlled. The CNN uses a customer-stratified split, so meters from one feeder fall into both training and test, while PI-STGAT holds out whole feeders; the CNN is trained with h_1–h_6 augmentation, which matches six of the eight test attacks, while the ablation configurations use none. Test prevalence is similar on average (0.136 for the CNN, 0.138 for PI-STGAT). The PI-STGAT variant trained with augmentation (and SSL) reaches 0.969 ± 0.009 / 0.984 ± 0.007, above the CNN, but again

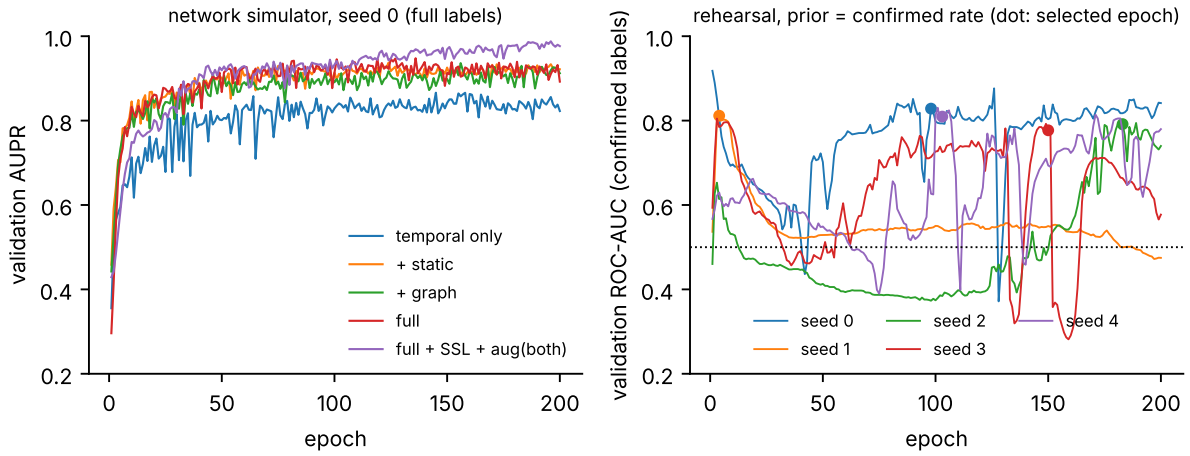


Figure 5: Validation curves from the training logs. Left: simulator, seed 0, full labels; all configurations are still improving slowly after 100 epochs. Right: rehearsal with the PU prior set to the confirmed rate, one line per export; dots mark the selected epoch. Validation ROC-AUC (against confirmed labels) spends long stretches below 0.5 on several exports.

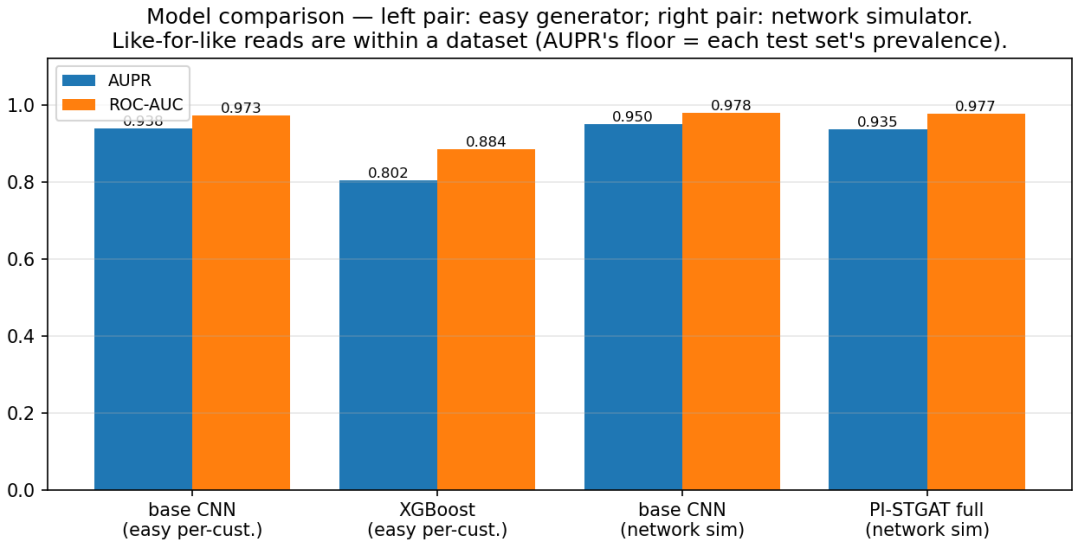


Figure 6: Model comparison, mean of 5 seeds. Left pair: per-customer generator. Right pair: network simulator. Bars within a pair share a dataset but not necessarily a split (see text).

under a different split. A comparison on the same feeder split with the same augmentation is needed before any architectural claim (Section 11).

9.2 Ablation and variants

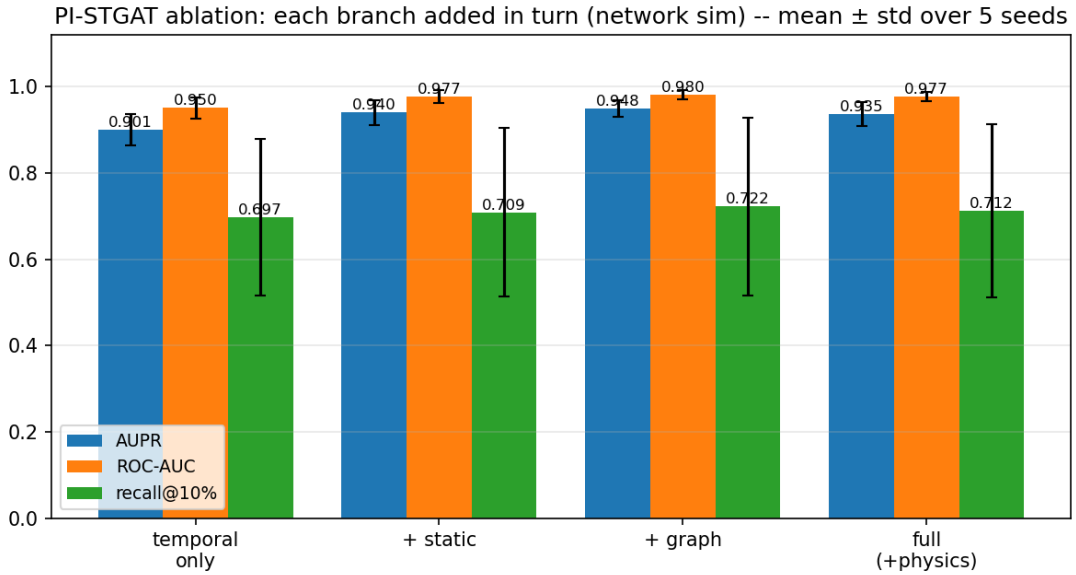


Figure 7: Ablation, mean ± s.d. over 5 seeds.

Configuration (5 seeds)	AUPR	ROC-AUC	R@10%
Temporal only	0.901 ± 0.037	0.950 ± 0.026	0.697 ± 0.181
+ static	0.940 ± 0.029	0.977 ± 0.014	0.709 ± 0.195
+ feeder attention	0.948 ± 0.019	0.980 ± 0.011	0.722 ± 0.205
+ physics (full)	0.935 ± 0.028	0.977 ± 0.010	0.712 ± 0.201
Full + SSL + augmentation	0.969 ± 0.009	0.984 ± 0.007	0.731 ± 0.214
Full + positional code	0.971 ± 0.007	0.988 ± 0.007	0.722 ± 0.205
Full, region input removed	0.939 ± 0.026	0.978 ± 0.012	0.722 ± 0.205
+ static, age and alarms label-free	0.950 ± 0.013	0.980 ± 0.003	0.713 ± 0.198
Full, age and alarms label-free	0.945 ± 0.022	0.981 ± 0.008	0.715 ± 0.201

Table 4: Ablation and variants, mean ± s.d. over 5 seeds.

Because each seed fixes the network and split, configurations can be compared seed by seed. Table 5 lists the paired AUPR differences.

- **Static attributes** raise AUPR on every seed (+0.039). The gain does not depend on the label-dependent meter age and alarm counts: with both redrawn independently of theft on the same networks, the gain over temporal-only is still positive on every seed (+0.049). It therefore comes from contracted power and region, which also carry theft signal by construction (Assumption 1).
- **Feeder attention** is not separable from noise (3/5).
- **The physics branch** lowers AUPR slightly on four of five seeds (−0.013). This is consistent with Proposition 2: the conservation term fixes feeder totals, not the within-feeder ranking that AUPR measures. Its value is the energy estimate $\hat{s}$ (Section 9.4).

Comparison	per-seed AUPR difference (seeds 0–4)	mean	higher on
+ static − temporal	+0.028, +0.027, +0.069, +0.027, +0.046	+0.039	5/5
+ attention − + static	+0.019, −0.006, −0.007, +0.001, +0.035	+0.008	3/5
full − + attention	−0.021, −0.033, −0.002, +0.001, −0.010	−0.013	1/5
full + SSL + aug − full	+0.021, +0.070, +0.022, +0.014, +0.042	+0.034	5/5
full + positional − full	+0.022, +0.074, +0.016, +0.003, +0.064	+0.036	5/5
full + positional − full + SSL + aug	+0.001, +0.004, −0.006, −0.011, +0.022	+0.002	3/5
full, region removed − full	+0.014, +0.003, −0.011, −0.002, +0.015	+0.004	3/5
+ static label-free − temporal	+0.042, +0.039, +0.053, +0.022, +0.089	+0.049	5/5

Table 5: Paired per-seed AUPR differences. Five seeds give little power; "5/5" is the strongest pattern five seeds can show, not a significance test.

- **A positional code** in the temporal encoder and **SSL with combined augmentation** each raise AUPR on every seed, by about 0.035, and end within 0.002 of each other. The SSL + augmentation run does not separate the two ingredients.
- **R@10%** has s.d. 0.18–0.21 in every configuration. Test prevalence ranges from 0.057 to 0.216 across seeds and R@k is capped at $k/(N\pi)$, so this spread comes mostly from the splits.

9.3 Per-attack recall



Figure 8: Recall@10% by attack type, mean of 5 seeds.

Per-step attacks h_3, h_4 and the zero window h_2 are found at 0.87–1.00 in every configuration. Uniform scaling h_1 rises from 0.35 (temporal only) to 0.53–0.56 once feeder attention or physics is added. The new seasonal attack h_7 is found at 0.81–0.94 and the ramp h_8 at 0.58–0.76. Energy-preserving reversal h_6 stays lowest, 0.28–0.42 (0.48 with the positional code); flat-mean h_5, also energy-preserving, is found at 0.60–0.84 because it removes variance, which permutation-invariant statistics detect.

Sample size. The test splits of the five seeds together contain 29–50 instances of each attack (for h_6: 6, 12, 6, 6, 6 per seed). Differences between cells of about 0.1 are within noise.

9.4 Energy recovery

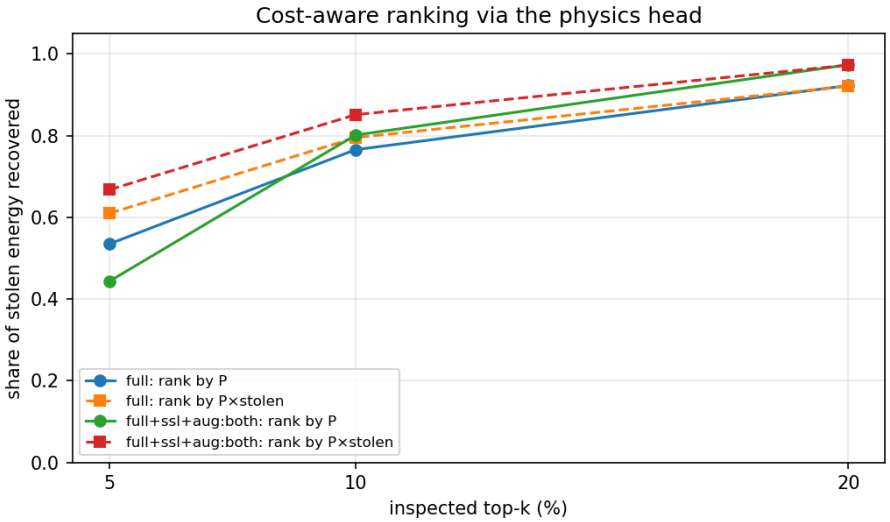


Figure 9: Share of stolen energy in the inspected top-k, mean of 5 seeds.

For the full model, inspecting the top 5%, 10% and 20% recovers 0.54, 0.77 and 0.92 of stolen energy when ranked by $\hat{p}$, and 0.61, 0.80 and 0.92 when ranked by $\hat{p}\hat{s}$. With SSL and augmentation the cost-aware ranking recovers 0.67, 0.85 and 0.97. The 5% value varies strongly between seeds (0.22–0.99 for the full model ranked by $\hat{p}$), so only multi-seed values should be quoted. Configurations without the physics branch have $\hat{s} \equiv 0$, so their $\hat{p}\hat{s}$ ranking is meaningless.

9.5 Regional audit

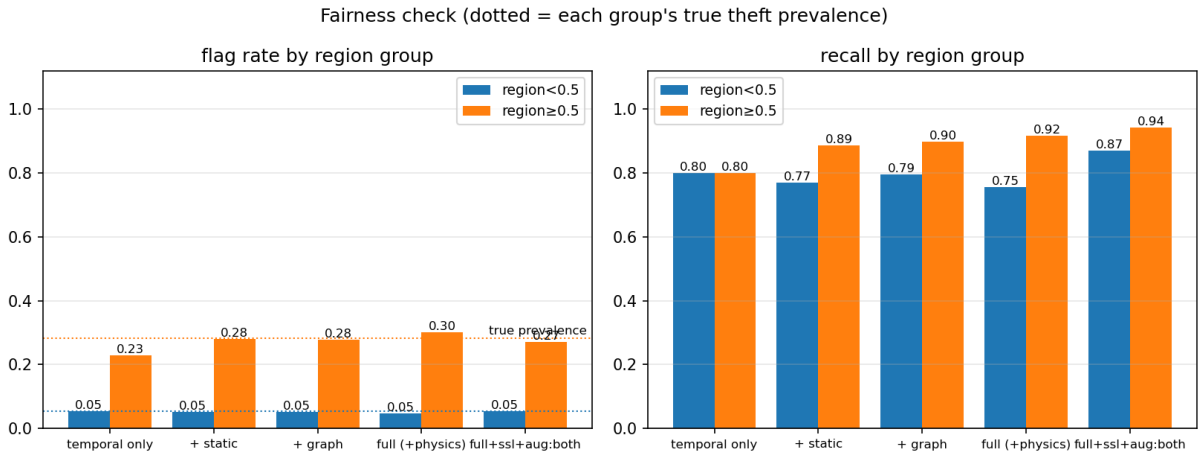


Figure 10: Flag rate and recall by region group, mean of 5 seeds. Dotted: group prevalence.

Group prevalence is 0.054 (low-region) and 0.283 (high-region). Flag rates follow prevalence: 0.05 in the low group for every configuration, and 0.23–0.30 in the high group. Recall at the operating threshold is balanced for the temporal-only model (0.80 vs 0.80) and becomes unbalanced when static attributes enter (full model 0.76 vs 0.92). Region is itself an input correlated with theft (ROC-AUC 0.71–0.79 alone). Removing it narrows the gap only from 0.16 to 0.13. The two strongest models narrow it more, by raising low-group recall: 0.85 vs 0.93 with the positional code, 0.87 vs 0.94 with SSL and augmentation.

9.6 Augmentation and attacks withheld from training

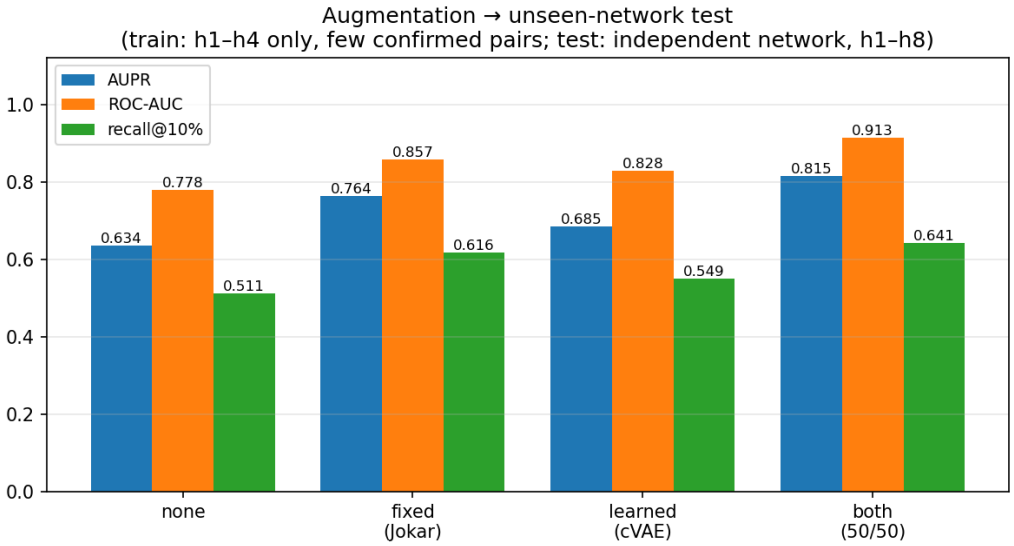


Figure 11: Temporal-only model trained on h_1–h_4 (38–50 confirmed pairs for the cVAE), tested on an independent network with all eight attacks. Mean of 5 seeds.

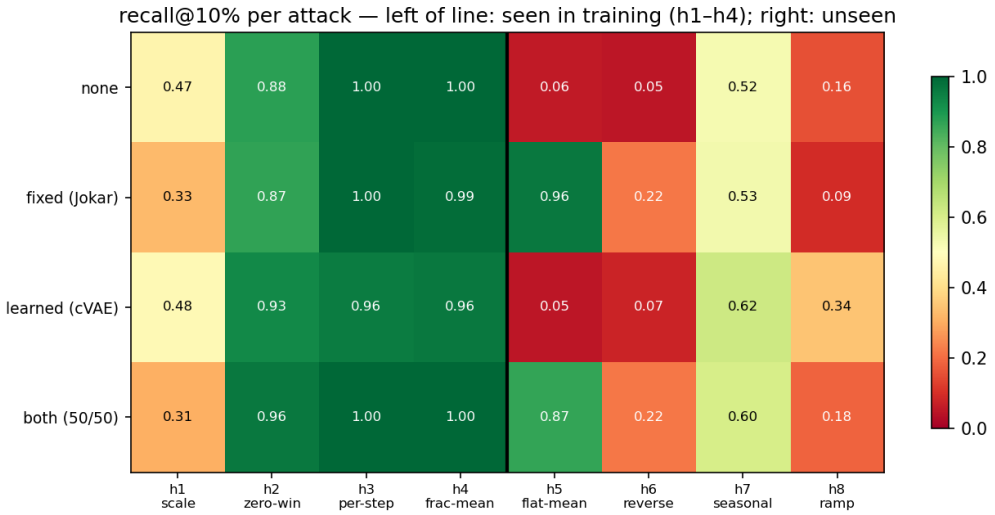


Figure 12: Per-attack recall@10% for the same experiment, mean of 5 seeds.

Mean AUPR / ROC-AUC over 5 seeds: no augmentation 0.634 / 0.778; fixed functions 0.764 / 0.857; learned cVAE 0.685 / 0.828; both 0.815 / 0.913. Paired against no augmentation, AUPR is higher on 5/5 seeds for both and for the fixed functions, and on 4/5 for the cVAE. The combined augmenter has higher AUPR than the fixed functions alone on 3/5 seeds.

The per-attack pattern matches Proposition 6:

- h_8 **ramp** is unseen by every variant and is a multiplicative under-reporting mask, inside the cVAE's support. The cVAE raises its recall on all five seeds (mean 0.16 → 0.34); the fixed functions never raise it (0.09).
- h_5 **and** h_6 are energy-preserving, outside the cVAE's support. The cVAE leaves h_5 unchanged (0.06 to 0.05); the fixed functions, which contain h_5 and h_6 by hand, raise h_5 to 0.96 and h_6 from 0.05 to 0.22. They are not unseen for that variant.

- h_7 (unseen) moves 0.52 / 0.53 / 0.62 / 0.60 (none / fixed / learned / both) with seed s.d. 0.13–0.26; no conclusion.
- h_1 falls from 0.47 to 0.33 with the fixed functions and to 0.31 with both (lower on 4/5 seeds), so fixed augmentation trades h_1 for h_5.

9.7 Deployment rehearsal

Exports. `make_fake_export.py` turns each seed's 60-feeder, 240-day simulated network into the CSV files a utility would provide, with defects injected: 10% of meters with 3–20-day gaps (about 30% of the missing readings exported as blank kWh rows), 5% late joiners, 1% dead meters, 1% meters missing from the topology file, 1% assigned to the wrong transformer, 1.5 kWh/day of unmetered load on every head, and 1% head noise. Thirty percent of thieves, chosen at random, go into the label file; truth is written separately and used only for evaluation.

Ingestion diagnostics (printed by the loader for the five exports): 1,072–1,304 meters kept, 35–39 dropped for coverage below 80%; 11–13 unmapped meters dropped, carrying 0.6–1.3% of metered load (the loader warns that this load stays in the residuals); 1–2 feeders per export flagged for negative residual (topology or CT errors) and one feeder in one export for residual above 40%; technical-loss estimate $\hat{\tau} = 0.061$–0.074; confirmed rate $\rho = 0.032$–0.044; true prevalence 0.105–0.145.

Evaluation set. "Out-of-sample" meters in the ranking file include the validation feeders, whose confirmed labels selected the training epoch. All rehearsal numbers below therefore use the 9 test feeders of each export only: 901 meters in total, 142 thieves (base rate 0.158), 40 of them confirmed.

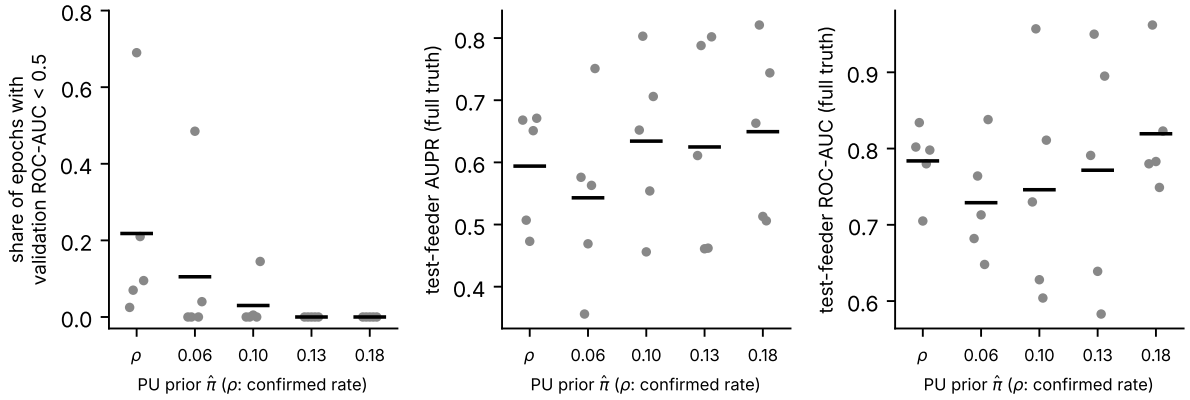


Figure 13: Prior sweep over five exports (grey: one export; black: mean). Left: share of training epochs with validation ROC-AUC below 0.5. Middle and right: AUPR and ROC-AUC on test feeders against the full truth, after model selection.

Ranking quality. With any prior, the top 5% of each test set contains 76–93% thieves against a base rate of 16%, and the top 10% contains 57–70%. Differences between priors are within the export-to-export spread; no prior is consistently best.

Training stability. With the confirmed-rate prior ($a < 0$ on every export), validation ROC-AUC fell below 0.5 for 2.5–69% of epochs depending on the export (Fig. 5); at $\hat{\pi} \geq 0.13$ it never did. The

$\hat{\pi}$	ρ	0.06	0.10	0.13	0.18
Epochs, val. ROC < 0.5	0.22 ± 0.27	0.10 ± 0.21	0.03 ± 0.06	0	0
Test AUPR vs truth	0.59 ± 0.10	0.54 ± 0.15	0.63 ± 0.13	0.63 ± 0.17	0.65 ± 0.14
Test ROC-AUC vs truth	0.78 ± 0.05	0.73 ± 0.07	0.75 ± 0.14	0.77 ± 0.16	0.82 ± 0.08
Hit rate, top 5%	$36/45 = 0.80$	$34/45 = 0.76$	$42/45 = 0.93$	$39/45 = 0.87$	$38/45 = 0.84$
Wilson 95%	[0.66, 0.89]	[0.61, 0.86]	[0.82, 0.98]	[0.74, 0.94]	[0.71, 0.92]
Hit rate, top 10%	$62/90 = 0.69$	$51/90 = 0.57$	$60/90 = 0.67$	$60/90 = 0.67$	$63/90 = 0.70$

Table 6: Prior sweep, test feeders only, mean ± s.d. over five exports; hit rates pooled over the five test sets (base rate 142/901 = 0.158, Wilson 95% [0.135, 0.183]). ρ is each export's confirmed rate, 0.032–0.044.

share falls monotonically on average as $\hat{\pi}$ increases, which is the instability Proposition 4 predicts. Selecting the best validation epoch recovered usable models in every case: at the operating threshold the confirmed-rate runs had flag rates of 0.02–0.39 across the two region groups, not zero. An earlier version of this report, using 20 training epochs, observed a flag rate of zero with this prior; that was not reproduced at 200 epochs.

The understatement factor. Proposition 7 predicts $\mathrm{AP}_{\mathrm{true}}/\mathrm{AP}_{\mathrm{vis}} \approx 1/c$. Over the 25 test-feeder evaluations (5 exports × 5 priors) the observed ratio has mean 3.5 (median 3.3, range 1.2–8.3); the predicted $1/c$ has mean 3.7 (median 3.8). The ratio is close to the prediction on average but varies widely in single evaluations, which involve 4–10 confirmed thieves each. On a real utility, where only confirmed labels exist, confirmed-only AUPR should be read as roughly a third of the true value at a 30% confirmation rate, with a wide margin.

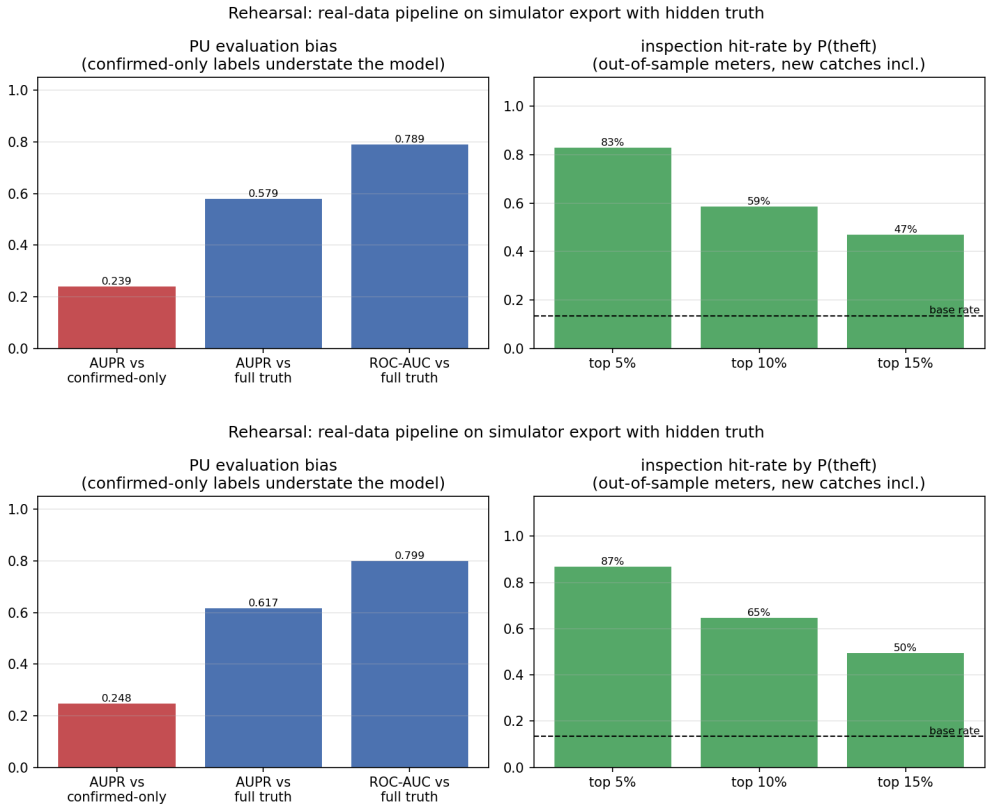


Figure 14: Rehearsal on out-of-sample meters (validation and test feeders), mean of 5 exports. Top: confirmed-rate prior. Bottom: $\hat{\pi} = 0.13$. Because validation feeders selected the epoch, these values are optimistic; Table 6 uses test feeders only.

SSL under scarce labels. On the simulator with 30% of thieves revealed (hidden on training and validation, full model), SSL gave test AUPR 0.732 ± 0.067 against 0.657 ± 0.125 without it, and ROC-AUC 0.894 against 0.857. Per seed, AUPR was higher with SSL on three seeds (+0.18, +0.22, +0.12) and lower on two (−0.14, −0.02). The mean favours SSL but five seeds do not settle it.

10 Discussion

What the evidence supports.

- On this simulator, ranking quality is high (AUPR 0.94–0.97, ROC-AUC 0.98–0.99 for the better configurations, five seeds). Static attributes, a positional code, and SSL with augmentation each improve it on every seed.
- The conservation identity holds in simulation with the predicted error level (correlation 0.94–0.98 over five networks), and the conservation head yields energy estimates whose cost-aware ranking captures 80–85% of stolen energy in the top 10%.
- Two predictions from the analysis are borne out: a calendar reference raises recall on reversal h_6 (Proposition 3 remark), and the mask cVAE helps exactly on the unseen attack inside its support (h_8, 5/5 seeds) and not on those outside it (Proposition 6).
- Confirmed-only evaluation understates true AUPR by about $1/c$ on average (Proposition 7).
- A prior below $\pi_u/2$ makes PU training unstable (Proposition 4); the instability falls as the prior grows. In practice a utility should set the prior from an audit estimate or above the confirmed rate, and must select epochs on validation data.
- In a rehearsal with realistic data defects, the top 5% of the ranking contains 76–93% thieves against a 16% base rate, pooled over five exports.

What it does not support.

- An advantage of PI-STGAT over a well-trained per-customer CNN: the uncontrolled comparison favours the CNN slightly.
- A benefit from feeder attention, or a discrimination benefit from the physics branch, at this network scale.
- Any real-world magnitude for the static-attribute gain (Assumption 1).
- A best PU prior, or a sharp threshold at $\hat{\pi} = \pi_u/2$.
- A benefit from SSL under scarce labels (3 of 5 seeds), or a separation of SSL from augmentation in the full-label runs.

10.1 Threats to validity

1. **Simulator authored by the investigator.** Attack forms, static-attribute signal strength and the loss model are design choices. The rehearsal tests robustness to data defects, not the realism of theft.
2. **SCAR.** Real confirmations come from targeted inspections, so confirmed thieves are not a random sample; PU learning under selection bias [1] would then be needed.
3. **Constant technical-loss share.** Losses vary with load (Fig. 2); unmetered loads bias $\hat{\tau}$.
4. **Feeder membership only.** The graph ignores within-feeder topology and phase.

5. **Five seeds, small counts.** Per-attack cells rest on 1–16 test instances per seed; each rehearsal test set has 9 feeders and 4–10 confirmed thieves.
6. **Model selection on validation AUPR** over 200 epochs picks favourable epochs, which helps most when training is unstable (PU with a low prior).
7. **Training length matters.** Several conclusions changed between 20-epoch and 200-epoch training (Section 12); the 200-epoch curves are still rising slowly (Fig. 5).

11 Next steps

1. Train the per-customer CNN and PI-STGAT on the same feeder split with the same augmentation, to settle the architectural question.
2. Apply the loader to a real utility export (meter series, meter-to-transformer map, transformer readings, inspection outcomes) and run a prospective pilot in which part of the inspection budget is allocated at random, so that hit rates can be compared causally and c estimated.
3. Estimate π_u from a small random audit; replace SCAR-based PU with a selection-bias-aware estimator.
4. Combine the positional code with SSL and augmentation, and separate SSL from augmentation; compare each meter's token sequence with its feeder mean before pooling, targeting h_6.
5. Evaluate ranking by $\hat{s}$ alone (remark on the ranking key); test larger networks (around 400 feeders) for a feeder-attention effect; extend the prior sweep above 0.18.

12 Changes since earlier versions

Code corrections (previous version). A code review found defects affecting the results or the real-data path; they were corrected and regression tests added (`tests/test_regressions.py`, 11 tests, run at the start of every pipeline run):

- Padding rows passed through batch normalisation (34% of training rows at default settings); they are now excluded.
- Blank kWh rows in an export were read as zero consumption; they are now missing data.
- The load of meters dropped for low coverage stayed in the head reading and looked like theft; it is now subtracted. Unmapped meters cannot be placed, so the loader warns and their load remains in the residuals.
- Under PU, the cVAE trained on hidden thieves, augmentation skipped them, and validation used hidden labels. All three are corrected.
- Results handling: `simple`-generator rows could enter the simulator bar of Fig. 6, and small test runs could replace full runs in the figures.
- New options: `-no-label-static`, `-no-region-feature`, `-pos-enc`. On real-format data the region column is no longer a model input.

This version. All results come from one five-seed run on the author's GPU with longer training (200 instead of 20 epochs for PI-STGAT; SSL 50 instead of 8; cVAE 2,000 instead of 400), and the rehearsal now uses one export per seed instead of a single export. Conclusions that changed relative to the 20-epoch, three-seed version:

- SSL with augmentation and the positional code now improve AUPR on every seed; earlier neither did.
- h_6 recall is 0.28 (0.48 with the positional code) instead of near the random level.
- The learned cVAE alone is now above no augmentation on 4/5 seeds (earlier below on all seeds), and raises recall on the unseen h_8 on every seed.
- The confirmed-rate prior no longer ends with zero flagged meters; its effect shows as training instability.
- The per-customer CNN on simulator data reaches AUPR 0.950, so the earlier statement that PI-STGAT recovers a large "cost of network realism" is withdrawn.
- The physics branch now lowers AUPR on 4/5 seeds; earlier it was within noise.

Reproducibility

Code: the package `ntl/` (simulator, data, model, losses, PU, cVAE, SSL, real-data loader, results logging); in `scripts/`, `train.py`, `baselines.py`, `export_sim_csv.py`, `train_pistgat.py`, `exp_augment.py`, `make_fake_export.py`, `eval_ranking.py`, `plot_results.py`, `plot_val_curves.py`, `plot_rehearsal_seeds.py`, `sim_analysis.py` and `report_numbers.py`; and `run_pipeline.sh`, which runs the regression tests and then every experiment for each seed, resuming after interruptions. The reported run is in `outputs/gpu_run/`: per-step logs, `results/results.csv`, `results/report_numbers.txt`, `results/rehearsal_seed_N.txt`, and figures per seed and averaged over seeds. The command and settings are in Appendix B. Figures 5 and 13 are produced by `python -m scripts.plot_rehearsal_seeds outputs/gpu_run report/figs`.

A Simulator constants

Quantity	Value	Note
Feeders, meters per feeder	150; $\mathcal{U}\{8,\dots,32\}$	rehearsal: 60 feeders
Days	365	rehearsal 240
Archetype probabilities	0.6 / 0.3 / 0.1	res / com / ind
Median level b_a	9 / 25 / 60 kWh/day	log-s.d. 0.45
Weekend factor	$\mathcal{U}(1.05,1.30)$ / $\mathcal{U}(0.40,0.70)$ / $\mathcal{U}(0.70,0.95)$	
Heating slope (per °C below 15)	$\mathcal{U}(0.02,0.05)$ / $\mathcal{U}(0,0.02)$ / $\mathcal{U}(0,0.01)$	
Cooling slope (per °C above 24)	$\mathcal{U}(0,0.02)$ / $\mathcal{U}(0.02,0.05)$ / $\mathcal{U}(0,0.01)$	
Contract factor on $\bar{x}$	$\mathcal{U}(1.4,2.4)$ / $\mathcal{U}(1.3,2.0)$ / $\mathcal{U}(1.2,1.8)$	
Hot-feeder probability; theft prob. hot / cold	0.25; 0.45 / 0.03	
Technical-loss share τ_f	$\mathcal{U}(0.04,0.09)$	realised mean 0.0635
Head noise	$\mathcal{N}(0,0.01^2)$ multiplicative	

Table 7: Constants in `ntl/simulator.py`.

B Training settings of the reported run

Setting	Value
Command	`run_pipeline.sh -seeds "0 1 2 3 4" -epochs 200 -base-epochs 150 -exp-epochs 100 -ssl-epochs 50 -cvae-epochs 2000`
Seeds	0, 1, 2, 3, 4 (each seed fixes the simulated network, the split and the initialisation)
Hardware	one NVIDIA RTX 4080; the whole run took about 24 minutes
Optimiser	Adam, lr 10^{-3}, weight decay 10^{-4}
PI-STGAT epochs; batch	200; 16 feeders
Baseline CNN epochs; batch	150; 128 customers
Unseen-attack experiment	100 epochs, augmentation probability 0.25
Model selection	best validation AUPR
λ (conservation)	0.5
Focal α, γ	0.75, 2
Augmentation probability	0.15 (main runs)
SSL	50 epochs, mask ratio 0.3, spans 5–21 days
cVAE	latent 16, hidden 128, mask length 64, $\beta = 0.01$, 2,000 epochs
Calibration	temperature in $[0.5, 10]$, L-BFGS on validation BCE
Splits	feeders 70/15/15 (PI-STGAT); customers stratified 70/15/15 (baselines)
Simulator	150 feeders, $T = 365$; rehearsal exports 60 feeders, $T = 240$

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